Unit 9

DOCUMENTATION

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of this chapter the students will be able to:

1. Define the Records and reports
2. List Purpose of Documentation
3. Understand the Methods of Documentation
4. Identify the General guide lines for documentation
5. Explain the Characteristic of Good Recording
6. Mention the Principles In Maintaining Records
7. List the type of records
8. Assist in Arrangement of records
9. List the Types of reports
10. Describe the Nurses responsibility in record keeping.

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9.1 INTRODUCTION

Mr. Arul is admitted in the Medical ward with fever. His temperature was 102 Degree F^0 (Farenheat). Sister Lucy gave Tablet. Paracetemol at 8am and went. At 08.10 am, Sister Mary came and checked the temperature, it was 102 Degree F. So, Sister Mary also gave one more Tablet Paracetemol.

Mr. Arul did not tell Sister Mary that he took one tablet already. Patient had 2 tablets instead of one tablet. It comes under Negligence and Malpractice, which is one of the legal issue. This is due to the poor communication between the sisters. Even if not able to communicate they should have entered in the patient chart. Patient chart is a ideal way of communicating the information to the next person. Since Sister Lucy did not record or enter in the chart, Mr. Arul had two tablets. This incident tells about the importance of recording and reporting. This chapter is going to discuss about the importance of documentation which includes recording and reporting.

Nursing practice needs accurate record keeping and careful documentation. The Nursing and Midwifery Council (NMC 2002) stated that 'good record keeping helps to protect the welfare of patients. Records and reports reveal the essential aspects of service in logical order, so that the new staff may be able to maintain continuity of service to individuals, families and communities.

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